

Part A: Case Study(Phishing)

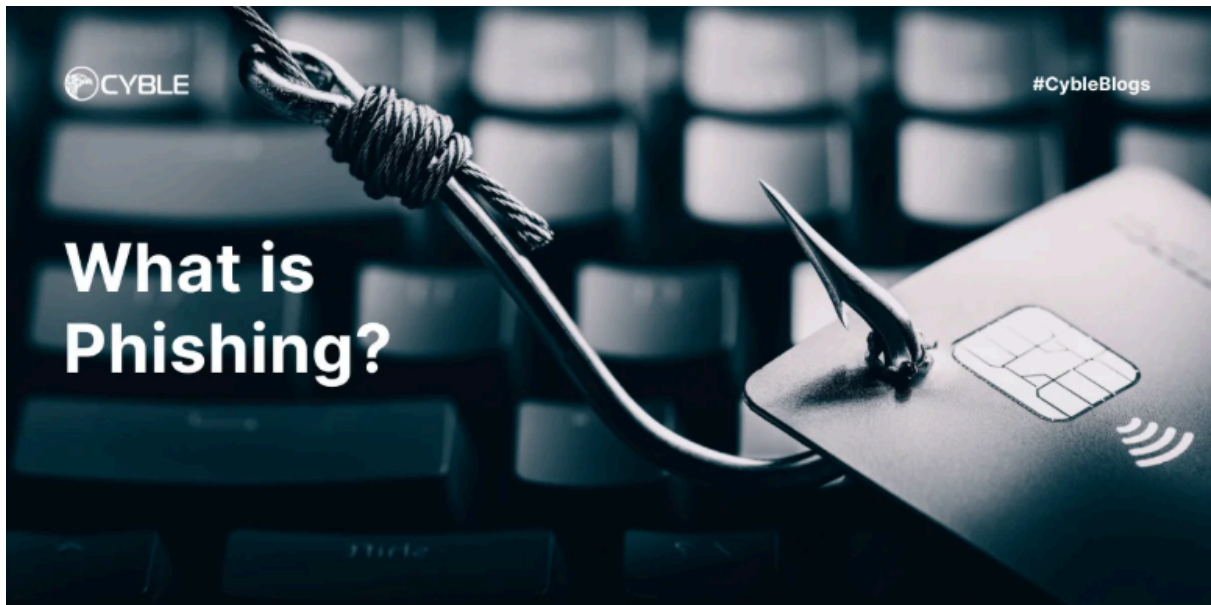
Case Study: Phishing

Phishing is a common type of cyber attack where attackers try to fool people into giving away sensitive information like passwords, bank details, or personal data. It usually looks like a message from a trusted source such as a bank, company, or social media platform, which makes it difficult to identify at first.

This type of attack generally follows a simple process. First, the attacker creates a fake email or message that appears genuine. Then, they send it to users with urgent or alarming content like “Your account will be suspended” or “Verify your details now.” When the user clicks on the link provided, it redirects them to a fake website that looks real. Without realizing, the user enters their personal information, which is directly collected by the attacker.

Phishing can target anyone who uses the internet, including students, working professionals, and even experienced users. People who are not aware of such scams are more likely to fall victim.

The impact of phishing can be serious. It may lead to financial loss, hacked accounts, and misuse of personal information. It can also cause stress and loss of trust. Therefore, being cautious and aware while using the internet is very important.



Part B - Prevention Checklist

Stay Safe Online: Prevention Checklist

1. Always use strong, unique passwords for all your online accounts and change them regularly.
2. Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) wherever possible to add an extra layer of security.
3. Never share your UPI PIN or banking passwords with anyone, not even friends or family.
4. Before making any online payment or UPI transaction, double-check the recipient's details carefully to avoid fraud.
5. Avoid clicking on suspicious links or downloading attachments from unknown emails or messages.
6. Keep your device's software and antivirus programs up to date to protect against malware.
7. Be cautious while sharing personal information on social media and avoid oversharing.
8. If you suspect any cybercrime or fraud, immediately report it to the **National Cyber Crime Portal** at cybercrime.gov.in or call the helpline at **1930**.



Part B - Prevention Checklist Report

Report on Learning from Phishing Case Study

While studying about phishing, what surprised me the most was how easily people can be tricked by messages that look completely genuine. I did not realize that attackers can create emails and websites that look almost exactly like real ones. The use of urgent messages like “account blocked” or “verify now” makes people panic and act quickly without thinking.

One habit I will definitely change is clicking on links without checking them properly. Earlier, I used to open links in emails or messages without verifying the source. Now, I will make sure to check the sender’s email address, avoid suspicious links, and never share personal information online without confirming authenticity.

This learning has made me more aware and careful while using the internet, which will help me stay safe from such cyber attacks.

